Question ID 1e11190a

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Systems of two linear equations in two variables	

ID: 1e11190a

Store A sells raspberries for $\$5.50$ per pint and blackberries for $\$3.00$ per pint. Store B sells raspberries for $\$6.50$ per pint and blackberries for $\$8.00$ per pint. A certain purchase of raspberries and blackberries would cost $\$37.00$ at Store A or $\$66.00$ at Store B. How many pints of blackberries are in this purchase?

A. 4

B. 5

C. 8

D. 12

ID: 1e11190a Answer

Correct Answer:
B

Rationale

Choice C is correct. It's given that store A sells raspberries for $\$5.50$ per pint and blackberries for $\$3.00$ per pint, and a certain purchase of raspberries and blackberries at store A would cost $\$37.00$. It's also given that store B sells raspberries for $\$6.50$ per pint and blackberries for $\$8.00$ per pint, and this purchase of raspberries and blackberries at store B would cost $\$66.00$. Let r represent the number of pints of raspberries and b represent the number of pints of blackberries in this purchase. The equation $5.50r + 3.00b = 37.00$ represents this purchase of raspberries and blackberries from store A and the equation $6.50r + 8.00b = 66.00$ represents this purchase of raspberries and blackberries from store B. Solving the system of equations by elimination gives the value of r and the value of b that make the system of equations true. Multiplying both sides of the equation for store A by 6.5 yields $(5.50r)(6.5) + (3.00b)(6.5) = (37.00)(6.5)$, or $35.75r + 19.5b = 240.5$. Multiplying both sides of the equation for store B by 5.5 yields $(6.50r)(5.5) + (8.00b)(5.5) = (66.00)(5.5)$, or $35.75r + 44b = 363$. Subtracting both sides of the equation for store A, $35.75r + 19.5b = 240.5$, from the corresponding sides of the equation for store B, $35.75r + 44b = 363$, yields $(35.75r - 35.75r) + (44b - 19.5b) = (363 - 240.5)$, or $24.5b = 122.5$. Dividing both sides of this equationby 24.5 yields $b = 5$. Thus, 5 pints of blackberries are in
this purchase.

Choices A and B are incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors. Choice D is incorrect. This is the number of pints of raspberries, not blackberries, in the purchase.

Question Difficulty:
Hard